Two-Column Academic Layout Reconstruction

Alice Example, Bob Sample, Carol Test

Abstract

We describe a synthetic two-column PDF fixture used to exercise reading-order reconstruction from raw coordinates. The title and abstract are full width, while the body below splits into two columns that share their baselines.

Keywords: pdf extraction; two-column layout; reading order

1 Introduction

Two-column text keeps lines short and readable; both sides share a common baseline on every wrapped row, so a horizontal scan crosses both columns in a single band of ease reading-order recovery from

Figure 1. Baseline-aligned rows

Table 1. Extraction accuracy

Method	Accuracy
Baseline	92.4%
Naive	71.2%

$E = m c^2$

Right-column prose is independent text that nevertheless shares each baseline with the left column rows, letting the extractor group them by the vertical coordinate alone. Captions are ordinary text and need no special handling to be located. Table rows use whitespace, not pipes, so column splits come from x values. Numbers stay exact and untranslated. References and the appendix appear after the columns as full-width bands.

References

[1] A. Example, B. Sample, C. Test. Reading Order from Coordinates. 2024.

Appendix A

Appendix content is ordinary text with no special markup.